Hosting the Flight Wall on Render (free tier)

What you get: a permanent public link (something like `https://flight-wall-xxxx.onrender.com`) that anyone can open in a browser — no install, no computer to keep on. Ami just opens the link.

What it costs: $0. The trade-offs of the free tier:

- The service sleeps after about 15 minutes with no visitors, and the first visit after a quiet spell takes about a minute to wake up. That's normal, not broken. While Ami has the board open, the 15-second refresh traffic counts as visits and keeps it awake.
- Free instance hours are capped at 750 per workspace per month — about a full month for one service like this, so one board fits.

Files you need

Put these four files in one GitHub repository (all in the same folder):

- `flight-wall.html`
- `flight-wall-server.py`
- `requirements.txt`
- `render.yaml`

Steps

1. **GitHub** (free account): this is just where the code lives so Render can read it — GitHub doesn't run the app. For that job it's the best pick: free, the standard choice, and Render's GitHub connection is the smoothest. (GitLab works with Render too, but there's no advantage to it here.) No git or command line needed — it's all in the browser:
    - Download the four files into one folder on your computer (they're attached in the chat).
    - Go to github.com, create a free account, and verify your email.
    - Click the **+** button at the top right and choose **New repository**.
    - Name it `flight-wall`. Choose **Public** — nothing private is in these files (no passwords, no keys, no personal data), and Public makes the Render connection simplest. Leave the "Add a README file" box unchecked, then click **Create repository**.
    - On the new repo page, click **Add file** and choose **Upload files** (or the "uploading an existing file" link if you see it).
    - Drag all four files into the upload area, or click "choose your files" and select them.
    - Scroll down and click the green **Commit changes** button. The default message ("Add files via upload") is fine.

    - You should now see all four files listed in the repo. That's it for GitHub.

2. **Render** (free account, no card required): Dashboard -> New -> Blueprint -> connect the GitHub repo -> Apply. Render reads `render.yaml` and creates a free web service.

   Without the Blueprint, the manual equivalent is: New -> Web Service -> connect the repo -> Environment: Python -> Start command: `python flight-wall-server.py` -> Plan: Free.

3. Wait for the deploy (a minute or two), then open the URL Render gives you. The board should load with live traffic around Logan.

4. Share that URL with Ami. She can set her own center and favorites in her browser — they live in her browser and don't affect yours.

Notes

- The server reads its port from the `PORT` variable Render sets, so no code changes are needed to deploy.
- The board only serves public ADS-B data, so there's nothing private in what Ami would see.
- If you ever want it always awake with no wake-up delay, that's Render's Starter plan (about $7/month) — same service, just change the plan.